

Agriculture in the Economy

Science

May, 2026



Agriculture in the Economy (A11584)

Short Title: Agriculture in the Economy
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster Business
Author JGERAGHTY
Credits 5

Level: Introductory

Description of Module / Aims

This module will enable the student to describe the structure of Irish agriculture and outline national and EU supports the agriculture sector. The student will gain an insight into the state agencies involved in policy creation and food promotion. The module will review the main farm enterprises as well as alternative enterprises, and describe the range of schemes and services available to Irish farmers.

Programmes

AGRI-0001	BSc in Agriculture (WD_SAGUL_D)	1 / 2 / M
AGRI-0001	BSc in Agriculture (WD_SAGUL_D)	2 / 4 / E

Indicative Content

- Structural trends in Irish agriculture
- Agencies involved in policy creation and food promotion
- EU Common Agricultural Policy
- Schemes and services available to Irish farmers
- Profile of main agricultural enterprises in Ireland
- Alternative enterprise production in Ireland
- Supply & demand for agricultural produce

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Review the importance of agriculture to the Irish economy.
2. Explain how agricultural policy is designed and developed.
3. Outline the structure and operation of the CAP - Pillar 1 and Pillar 2.
4. Describe each agricultural sector and target markets at home and abroad.
5. Discuss factors which influence supply and demand of agricultural produce.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Practical instruction.
- Written assignments - exam and briefing note.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	60%	1,2,5
Continuous Assessment	40%	
<i>In-Class Assessment</i>	20%	3
<i>Assignment</i>	20%	4

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Very little knowledge and understanding of the subject matter. Unable to demonstrate critical thinking about key module areas.

40%-49%: Demonstrate satisfactory general knowledge of the key learning outcomes. Able to source relevant data and information and present it in both assignment and exam.

50%-59%: Demonstrate good knowledge of the main subject matter areas including good understanding about the contribution of agriculture to the Irish economy.

60%-69%: Demonstrate more detailed knowledge of all module topics including EU agricultural policy and its influence on domestic production.

70%-100%: Demonstrate comprehensive knowledge and understanding of all learning outcomes including the ability to evaluate and relate topics that overlap all learning outcomes.

Note:

- In addition to the normal regulations, a minimum of 35% must be achieved in both the final exam and continuous assessment components of the module. In cases where continuous assessment has a practical component attendance of at least 75% in the practicals is mandatory.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	32	
Tutorial	4	
Independent Learning	99	

Essential Material

- Department of Agriculture, Food and the Marine. 'Factsheet on Irish Agriculture', Dublin. Annual.
- Economics and Planning Division, DAFM. 'Annual Review & Outlook for Agriculture, Food and the Marine'. Dublin: Department of Agriculture, Food and the Marine, Annual.
- Hennessy, T. and B. Moran. 'National Farm Survey'. Galway: Teagasc, Annual.

Supplementary Material

- An Bord Bia. 'Origin Green - Sustainability Report', Dublin. 2015.